

Πορφύριος ὁ Τύριος

Porphyry of Tyre on Abstinence and Neoplatonic Philosophy

eul_aid: udm

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή φιλοσοφική [Philosophical Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Neoplatonist](#)

Porphyry of Tyre was a philosopher of the late Roman Empire, active in the 3rd and 4th centuries CE. He was a major figure in the Neoplatonic school of thought. Born in the city of Tyre, he studied in Athens before moving to Rome to join the circle of the philosopher Plotinus, becoming his devoted disciple.

After Plotinus's death, Porphyry performed crucial work by editing and publishing his teacher's writings as the *Enneads* and composing a biography of him. Porphyry was a prolific writer across many formats. His surviving works include the *Isagoge*, an introduction to logic that became a standard textbook for centuries, the *Life of Plotinus*, a treatise *On Abstinence from Animal Food*, and allegorical interpretations of Homeric poetry. Many of his other works, including extensive commentaries and a major polemic *Against the Christians*, are lost, surviving only in fragments quoted by his opponents.

Modern scholars regard Porphyry as a central figure in systematizing and transmitting Neoplatonism. His editorial work preserved Plotinus's ideas, and his own writings sought to harmonize the philosophies of Plato and Aristotle. His logical works, especially the *Isagoge*, had a profound influence on medieval philosophy in the Byzantine, Arabic, and Latin traditions. His forceful critiques of Christianity also made him a significant, though controversial, intellectual opponent of the early Church.

Works (27)

- Κατὰ Χριστιανῶν · [Against the Christians](#) · 61 passages
- Βιβλίον Α' Ὀμηρικῶν ζητημάτων ἔκδοσις Β · [Book I of Homeric Questions Version B](#) · 3 passages
- Βιβλίον Α' Ὀμηρικῶν ζητημάτων ἔκδοσις Τ · [Book I of Homeric Questions Version T](#) · 1 passages
- Βιβλίον Α' Ὀμηρικῶν ζητημάτων · [Book I of Homeric Questions Version V](#) · 133 passages
- Ἰλιακῶν προβλημάτων βιβλίον α (ἔκδοσις Χ) · [Book I of Homeric Questions Version X](#) · 127 passages
- Χρονικά · [Chronicles](#) · 53 passages
- Ὑπομνήματα εἰς Ἀριστοτέλην Ἑλληνιστί · [Commentaries-Aristotle in Greek](#) · 22 passages
- Ὑπόμνημα εἰς Πλάτωνος Τίμαιον · [Commentary on Plato's Timaeus \(Book I\)](#) · 73 passages
- Ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Τίμαιον · [Commentary on Plato's Timaeus \(Fragment\)](#) · 1 passages
- Ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Παρμενίδην · [Commentary-Plato's Parmenides](#) · 14 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα τῆς ἱστορίας τῆς φιλοσοφίας · [Fragments of the History of Philosophy](#) · 18 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῶν Ἑπτὰ Σοφῶν · [Fragments on the Seven Sages](#) · 63 passages
- Πρὸς Ἀνεβῶνα ἐπιστολή · [Letter to Anebon](#) · 50 passages

- [Βίος Πλωτίνου · Life of Plotinus · 34 passages](#)
- [Βίος Πυθαγόρου · Life of Pythagoras · 61 passages](#)
- [Περὶ Ἀποχῆς · On Abstinence · 182 passages](#)
- [Περὶ Κατηγοριῶν Ἀριστοτέλους · On Aristotle's Categories, Exposition by Question and Answer · 837 passages](#)
- [Περὶ φιλοσοφίας ἐκ χρησμῶν · On Philosophy from Oracles · 61 passages](#)
- [Περὶ ἀγαλμάτων · On Statues · 13 passages](#)
- [Περὶ τοῦ Νυμφῶν Ὑαντροῦ · On the Cave of the Nymphs · 37 passages](#)
- [Εἰς τὰ ἁρμονικὰ Πτολεμαίου ὑπόμνημα · On the Harmonics of Ptolemy, Commentary · 172 passages](#)
- [Ζητήματα τοῦ Βατικανοῦ κώδικος · On the Vatican Codex · 88 passages](#)
- [Λεῖψανα Ὀμηρικῶν ζητημάτων περὶ τὴν Ἰλιάδα · Remains of Homeric Questions Pertaining to the Iliad · 3 passages](#)
- [Λεῖψανα Ὀμηρικῶν ζητημάτων περὶ τὴν Ὀδύσσειαν · Remains of Homeric Questions Pertaining to the Odyssey · 311 passages](#)
- [Ἀποφθέγματα πρὸς Νοητά · Sentences Leading to Intelligibles · 38 passages](#)
- [Μαρτυρίαι · Testimonies · 3 passages](#)
- [Πρὸς Μάρκελλαν · To Marcella · 35 passages](#)

Other Neoplatonist Authors

- [Ἀμελίου Ἐπιστολή · Amelius Letters · 1 work](#)
- [Ἀμμώνιος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Ammonius of Alexandria Phil · 5 works](#)
- [Δαμάσκιος ὁ Δαμασκηνός · Damascius of Damascus · 7 works](#)
- [Δαβίδ ὁ Ἀνίκητος · David the Invincible · 2 works](#)
- [Δέξιππος ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Dexippus the Neoplatonist · 1 work](#)
- [Ἡλίας ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Elias the Neoplatonist · 3 works](#)
- [Εὐσέβιος ὁ Μύνδιος · Eusebius of Myndus · 1 work](#)
- [Ἱεροκλῆς ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Hierocles of Alexandria · 1 work](#)
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Ἀνώνυμος · Iamblichus Anonymous · 1 work](#)
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεὺς · Iamblichus of Chalcis · 6 works](#)
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεὺς · Iamblichus of Chalcis II · 1 work](#)
- [Ἰουλιανὸς ὁ Ἀποστάτης · Julian the Apostate · 20 works](#)